ChatGuard

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From liability to asset: communications intelligence for regulated trading firms

How ChatGuard turns the Bloomberg chat archive into desk intelligence — and audit-ready compliance — on a single captured record, deployed inside your own perimeter.

Executive summary

Regulated firms already capture and store enormous volumes of Bloomberg chat, email and voice. Yet for most, that archive is pure liability: written for the regulator, read by no one, and mined for nothing. Two pressures are converging — escalating recordkeeping enforcement, and desks that need faster, data-driven decisions. ChatGuard answers both from the same encrypted record.

- **The risk is real and growing.** Since 2021, the SEC, CFTC and FINRA together have levied over $3.5bn for failures to capture and preserve off-channel communications; the FCA imposed £52.8m in fines in 2023.
- **The archive is an untapped asset.** The same conversations that create compliance risk also contain RFQs, quotes, fills, counterparty behaviour and commitments the desk never systematically sees.
- **One platform, two engines.** ChatGuard runs Desk Intelligence (for traders) and Compliance & HR (for the firm) on one record, deployed inside the client's perimeter.

1. The regulatory squeeze

Communications surveillance is no longer a checkbox. Across jurisdictions, firms must capture, retain and supervise business communications across every channel — and demonstrate it on demand. The relevant regimes include the FCA's SYSC and the Market Abuse Regulation, MiFID II, the SEC's Rule 17a-4 and FINRA's supervision rules, alongside data-protection law such as the UK GDPR. The recent wave of enforcement has focused specifically on **off-channel communications** — WhatsApp, Signal and personal devices — where records were never captured.

$3.5bn+	£52.8m
SEC/CFTC/FINRA off-channel recordkeeping fines since 2021	Total FCA fines, 2023

2. The cost of an unread archive

Capturing communications is the easy part; most firms already do it. The failure is that the archive is inert. On the compliance side, lexical keyword searches over millions of messages generate noise, miss context, and leave investigators reconstructing events by hand. On the desk side, the richest real-time record of how the business actually trades — who asked for what, who quoted, how fast, who filled, what was promised — is never structured or measured. The same data is simultaneously a compliance burden and a wasted asset.

3. One captured record, two engines

ChatGuard reads a single, encrypted, immutable record of communications and serves two audiences from it.

Desk Intelligence	Compliance & HR
• RFQ / quote / fill extraction from free-text chat • Deal reconstruction with time-to-quote & time-to-fill • Counterparty analytics — hit rate & sentiment • Open follow-up tracking • Unified search and JSON/CSV export	• Immutable, tamper-evident archiving (5y+) • Alerts mapped to market-abuse typologies • Off-channel & information-barrier detection • HR investigation toolkit with evidence trail • One-click regulator audit packs

4. How extraction works

ChatGuard turns unstructured chat into structured intelligence in four stages, all inside the client's perimeter:

- **Capture** — Bloomberg IB chat and persistent rooms, email, voice transcripts and approved messaging, normalised into one record. Bloomberg capture uses the firm's compliance/archival entitlement (e.g. Bloomberg Vault).
- **Parse & classify** — NLP tuned for trading shorthand identifies RFQs, quotes and fills and the instruments and sizes involved.
- **Enrich & reconstruct** — events are linked into deals, counterparties are resolved across aliases, sentiment is scored, and messages are mapped to market-abuse typologies.
- **Surface** — a desk dashboard, a compliance console, real-time alerts and exportable audit packs.

5. Architecture, security & data residency

ChatGuard is deployed inside the client's own environment — self-hosted or in a private cloud — so communications never leave the perimeter. Records are encrypted end-to-end and held in an immutable, tamper-evident store with the agreed retention (5+ years). Access is governed by SSO and role-based permissions, network access can be IP allow-listed, and every reviewer action is logged. Monitoring must be proportionate and disclosed to staff in line with applicable employment and data-protection law; ChatGuard supplies templates but does not provide legal advice.

6. Illustrative parallel run

The figures below illustrate the kind of output a two-hour FX/rates session produces when ChatGuard runs in parallel with an incumbent tool. They are illustrative, not a specific client result.

Metric	Before (keyword tool)	With ChatGuard
Trade events structured	manual	RFQs, quotes & fills auto-extracted
Deals reconstructed	none	RFQ → quote → fill with timing
Counterparties	raw mentions	resolved across aliases, with sentiment
Surveillance alerts	keyword noise	grouped by market-abuse typology
Audit pack	hours, by hand	one click

7. Getting started

A typical rollout runs 4–8 weeks: scoping and legal sign-off (DPA and staff notification), in-perimeter deployment, capture integration, rule configuration, and a parallel run on the client's own data before go-live. Firms can start with a single engine and add the other later on the same record.

See what your conversations have been telling you

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